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GULF NEWS

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UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED MEETS EGYPTIAN PRESIDENT

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan meets Abdel Fattah Al Sisi, President of Egypt, at Masdar City yesterday. Their talks reviewed fraternal ties and cooperation across a range of fields, with a focus on priority areas that serve the development ambitions of both countries. The leaders addressed a number of regional and international issues of mutual interest, including developments in the Middle East.

UAE slams Israel's West Bank moves

Joint statement by
several countries
condemns illegal
Israeli decisions

ABU DHABI

The Foreign Ministers of the UAE, Turkey, Egypt, Jordan, Indonesia, Pakistan, Saudi Arabia, and Qatar condemned in the strongest terms the illegal Israeli decisions and measures aimed at imposing unlawful Israeli sovereignty, entrenching settlement activity, and enforcing a new legal and administrative reality in the occupied West Bank, thereby accelerating attempts at its illegal annexation and the displacement of the Palestinian people. They reaffirmed that Israel

PALESTINE'S PLEA

Ambassador Muhannad Al Aklouk, Palestine's permanent representative to the Arab League Council, has submitted an urgent request for an extraordinary session of the Arab League Council to convene at the level of permanent representatives, to discuss recent aggressive decisions issued by the Israeli government.

has no sovereignty over the occupied Palestinian territory. The Ministers warned against the continued expansionist Israeli policies and illegal measures pursued by the Israeli government in the occupied West Bank, which fuel violence and

conflict in the region. The Ministers expressed their absolute rejection of these illegal actions, which constitute a blatant violation of international law, undermine the two-state solution, and represent an assault on the inalienable right of the Palestinian people to realise their independent and sovereign state on the June 4, 1967 lines, with occupied Jerusalem as its capital.

The Ministers affirmed that these illegal measures in the occupied West Bank are null and void and constitute a clear violation of UN Security Council resolutions. They renewed their call on the international community to fulfil its legal and moral responsibilities and to compel Israel to halt its dangerous escalation in the occupied West Bank and the inciting statements of its officials. — WAM

UAE to use 'Heart in a Box' tech

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE Ministry of Health and Prevention (MoHAP) has showcased an advanced organ preservation technology known as 'Heart in a Box' on the opening day of World Health Expo (WHX) 2026, highlighting the country's growing role in innovation-driven organ donation and transplantation.

The technology uses machine perfusion to preserve and assess vital organs, including the heart, liver, lungs and kidneys, outside the human body, significantly extending their viability prior to transplantation while maintaining functional quality.

Dr Ali Abdulkarim Al Obaidli, Chairman of the National Committee for Organ Transplantation, Hayat, told *Gulf News*: "It gives us hope for transplanting organs when the donor and recipient are located in countries far away from each other."

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Dubai allows the resale of property stakes for 1st time

Secondary market
trading from
February 20 under
regulated framework

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Dubai has taken another step toward using digital technology in its property market after the Dubai Land Department announced Phase II of its Real Estate Tokenisation Project.

This stage allows resale of tokenised properties in the secondary market from February 20, moving the project beyond testing into real market use.

The department said this step shows progress toward a regulated, technology-based way of buying and selling property. The goal is to introduce digital tools into real estate in a controlled manner, while keeping strong rules in place to protect investors and ensure transparency.

Phase II follows a pilot launched in March under the REES Real Estate Innovation Initiative. That initial stage focused on testing whether prop-

erty could be divided into digital units under existing laws, systems, and title deed registration processes.

Pilot phase

The pilot was carried out with the Virtual Assets Regulatory Authority and several strategic partners. During this period, authorities examined how tokenised property ownership could work alongside Dubai's current property registration and ownership framework.

Dubai Land Department said the pilot proved that real estate tokenisation can operate safely within a regulated system. As a result, Dubai has become the first real estate registration authority in the region to adopt this approach under official regulatory supervision.

Tokenisation means a property is split into digital units, known as tokens, with each token representing a share of ownership. These tokens can be bought, sold, or transferred through approved platforms, under strict regulatory rules.

Phase II focuses on enabling resale. About 7.8 million real estate tokens will be available for trading in the secondary market under a controlled pilot structure.

Dubai welcomes 19.59m overseas visitors in 2025

INTERNATIONAL OVERNIGHT ARRIVALS
ROSE BY 5 PER CENT YEAR ON YEAR

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dubai welcomed 19.59 million international overnight visitors in 2025, marking a 5 per cent year-on-year increase and extending the emirate's record-breaking tourism performance into a third consecutive year, according to data released by the Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism.

The figures underline Dubai's continued recovery and growth as one of the world's leading tourism destinations. Average hotel occupancy reached 80.7 per cent, up from 78.2 per cent in 2024, reflecting strong demand throughout the year. Occupied hotel room nights rose 4 per cent to 44.85 million, supported by a total hotel inventory of 154,264 rooms across 827 establishments.

Dubai closed the year with more than two million international visitors in a single month for the first time, welcoming 2.04 million visitors in December, a 6 per cent increase compared with the same month a year earlier.

Record-breaking figures

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, said the performance reflects the emirate's long-term vision and coordinated public- and private-sector efforts. "For the third year in a row, Dubai's tourism sector has achieved record-breaking figures. In 2025, the emirate welcomed 19.59 million international overnight visitors, up 5 per

SOURCE MARKETS

- **Western Europe** accounted for 4.1 million visitors, or 21% of total arrivals, up from 3.74 million in 2024
- **CIS and Eastern Europe:** 2.89 million (15%)
- **South Asia:** 2.89 million (15%)
- **GCC countries:** 2.89 million (15%)
- **Mena (excluding GCC):** 2.17 million (11%)
- **North East and South East Asia:** 1.85 million (9%)
- **Americas:** 1.40 million (7%)
- **Africa:** 897,000 (5%)
- **Australasia:** 401,000 (2%)

cent year-on-year, while average hotel occupancy exceeded 80 per cent, according to the Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism," Sheikh Hamdan tweeted.

"This strong momentum reinforces Dubai's position as a year-round destination and supports the Dubai Economic Agenda, D33's goal to rank among the world's top 3 tourism hubs. At the crossroads of the world, Dubai continues to welcome visitors to experience its unique offering," Sheikh Hamdan added.

Average daily room rates increased to Dh579, up 8 per cent from 2024, while revenue per available room (RevPAR) rose 11 per cent to Dh467. Guests stayed an average of 3.7 nights, highlighting sustained demand across leisure, business, and events-driven travel.

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Dr Vinod Metta explains how, with the right medical guidance, Parkinson's patients can fast safely during the holy month

IN FOCUS

Taste of Dubai: A playground for chefs and party for food lovers | P6-7



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